DATE: October 15, 2026

TO: Dr. Haris Vikalo
Mugdha Jadao

FROM: Ethan Chua
Esteban Martinez
Li Shi
Andrew Yin
Abhirit Das

SUBJECT: Project Definition for BevoTag, an Open Asset-Tracking Tag for the UT Austin Campus

INTRODUCTION

This Project Definition states the design problem that the BevoTag team will solve in Senior Design and explains how the five-member team has organized itself to solve it. BevoTag is a small tag that a student or staff member attaches to a laptop, bag, or piece of university equipment to locate it anywhere on the University of Texas at Austin campus. Global Positioning System (GPS) signals do not penetrate well indoors [1, Sec. I], and consumer tags such as the Apple AirTag update an item's location only when a nearby phone from the same manufacturer detects them [2]. BevoTag is an open tag because it needs no manufacturer's phone network: it estimates the item's position from campus Wi-Fi and its own motion sensor and reports that position to its owner on a campus map. The team will build a tag, firmware, a building survey, and an application that together place an item in the correct room in more than 90% of trials.

The design problem is to track an item continuously, indoors and outdoors, without new infrastructure. Wi-Fi measurements alone can mislocate a device by several meters because signals fluctuate as the environment changes [1], [3, Table 4]. A low-cost motion sensor alone drifts even faster, by more than 150 m within 60 s [4]. Combining the two lets each correct the other. The project will test this approach in surveyed areas beginning with the Engineering Education and Research Center (EER). Radio, data-security, and battery-safety standards constrain the design, as does university network policy, and the team commits to recording no one's network traffic, to encrypting and limiting location data, and to using the campus network only as an ordinary client.

Measurable targets and a two-sub-team organization turn this approach into a plan. Beyond room identification, the system must keep its median position error under 5 m, update an item's location at least every 10 s while the item moves, and run at least 24 hours on one battery charge. Esteban Martinez and Li Shi will build the tag hardware and firmware, Andrew Yin and Abhirit Das will build the localization software and the user application, and Ethan Chua will coordinate the work as Project Lead. Shared policies for communication, review, and decisions govern every member.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

BevoTag must locate a tagged item to within a few meters across indoor and outdoor areas of campus, using only existing campus Wi-Fi and its own motion sensor. Buildings block and reflect satellite signals [5], and low-cost motion sensors drift [4], so no single source of position is reliable on its own. The Design Problem Description explains why fusing Wi-Fi fingerprints with motion sensing is the most promising approach and what that approach must overcome. The Requirements Specification then sets the measurable targets that a successful design must meet.

Design Problem Description

A successful BevoTag design must estimate an item's location indoors and outdoors without infrastructure the team cannot control, and it must show that location to the item's owner on a map. Existing trackers fail this need because satellite signals do not reach indoors and crowdsourced tags depend on passing phones. BevoTag addresses the need by fusing Wi-Fi fingerprints with motion sensing, an approach that brings three main challenges: limited power on the tag, radio signals that change from moment to moment, and sensor drift. Because the tag reports location, the design must also satisfy radio, data-security, and battery-safety standards and protect the privacy of bystanders and owners.

The Need for On-Campus Item Tracking

Students, faculty, and staff need a way to find misplaced items anywhere on the main UT Austin campus, known as the Forty Acres. Laptops, bags, and shared university equipment move between classrooms, labs, libraries, and outdoor plazas many times a day, and an item left behind can be anywhere among dozens of multistory buildings. A useful tracker must therefore work

indoors, on any floor, and in the narrow outdoor spaces between tall buildings. The team's goal is tracking that needs neither new infrastructure, such as beacons installed in every building, nor a passerby who owns a particular brand of smartphone.

Why Existing Solutions Fall Short

Each of the three existing approaches to tracking fails on campus. Satellite positioning cannot reach indoors, crowdsourced Bluetooth tags stop updating when no compatible phone passes by, and Wi-Fi positioning that relies on signal strength alone often errs by enough to place an item in the wrong room.

Satellite positioning fails indoors and degrades between tall buildings. Global Navigation Satellite Systems (GNSS), the family of satellite positioning systems that includes GPS, compute a receiver's position from faint signals that satellites broadcast from about 20,200 km above the Earth [6]. These signals do not penetrate well indoors [1, Sec. I]. Between tall buildings, signal blockage and multipath, the arrival of signals only after they reflect off nearby walls, degrade GNSS so much that earlier precise receivers without inertial aiding reported root-mean-square position errors greater than 9 m [5, Sec. 1.1.1].

Crowdsourced tags locate an item only when a compatible phone happens to pass nearby. The Apple AirTag and the Samsung Galaxy SmartTag broadcast a short-range Bluetooth signal, and nearby phones from the same manufacturer detect that signal and report its location [2], [7]. In an empty lab at night no such phone passes by, so the tag's location stops updating until one does.

Wi-Fi positioning that relies only on signal strength is too coarse for reliable room-level tracking. These systems estimate position from the received signal strength indicator (RSSI), a measure of how strong each nearby Wi-Fi signal is when it reaches the device. Signal strength fluctuates as people move and the environment changes [1, Sec. III-B], so RSSI fingerprinting typically locates a device only to within 1 to 5 m [3, Table 4], which can place it in the wrong room.

Theory of Operation

BevoTag combines two sources of position information whose errors differ: campus Wi-Fi measurements, which are noisy but do not drift, and a motion sensor, which is smooth over short periods but drifts. A fusion algorithm uses each source to correct the other. The final design may compute this estimate on the tag or on a server; the team will decide after measuring the prototype hardware, as the Design Challenges explain.

The system locates the tag by matching its Wi-Fi measurements against a survey of each building. UT Austin operates campus Wi-Fi networks, including utexas-iot, which serves Internet of Things devices [8]. In addition to RSSI, some Wi-Fi chips report channel state information (CSI), the frequency response of each of dozens of narrow sub-carriers [9], which shows how much the path weakens and delays the signal on each sub-carrier. Walls, furniture, and room geometry shape these values, so CSI acts as a detailed fingerprint of a location [10]. The team will first survey a building by recording Wi-Fi measurements at many points whose positions it knows. The system can then estimate the tag's position by finding the survey points whose measurements best match the tag's current measurements.

A motion sensor tracks the tag between Wi-Fi fixes but drifts when it runs alone. An inertial measurement unit (IMU), similar to the sensor that rotates a smartphone's screen, measures acceleration along three axes and rotation about them. Adding up these measurements from a known starting point, a technique called dead reckoning, tracks the tag's movement many times per second. Small sensor errors accumulate, however, so the estimate drifts farther from the truth the longer it runs: a simple low-cost inertial system can accumulate more than 150 m of average position error within 60 s [4].

A fusion algorithm combines the two sources so that the result neither jumps like Wi-Fi alone nor drifts like the IMU alone. A standard candidate is the extended Kalman filter (EKF) [11], which uses the IMU to predict how the tag has moved and uses each new Wi-Fi fix to correct the accumulated drift, weighting each source by how reliable it currently is. Outdoors, where satellite signals are available, the same algorithm can also accept a GNSS position as an optional third source.

Design Functionality and Scope

BevoTag is a system of a tag, a location server, and a user application that together turn Wi-Fi and motion measurements into a position on a campus map. The project covers a working prototype that the team will test in surveyed areas, starting with EER. It excludes cellular connectivity, a campus-wide survey, mass-production tooling, and the tracking of people.

Any BevoTag design must measure, transmit, estimate, and display, as Figure 1 shows. The tag measures nearby Wi-Fi signals and its own motion (step 1) and sends these measurements over the campus Wi-Fi network to the location server (step 2). The server combines them with a previously recorded survey of the building to estimate the tag's position, or it receives an estimate that the tag computed itself (step 3). The user application then displays that position on a campus map (step 4). To deliver this behavior, any BevoTag design must perform four functions:

- **Wi-Fi measurement:** record the RSSI and, where the hardware supports it, the CSI of signals from nearby campus access points in the 2.4 GHz band.
- **Motion tracking:** sample the IMU's acceleration and rotation fast enough to follow a walking person carrying the tag.
- **Position estimation:** fuse the motion data with Wi-Fi position fixes, correcting the drift that accumulates in the motion estimate.
- **Reporting:** send the latest position and device status to an application that the owner can view.

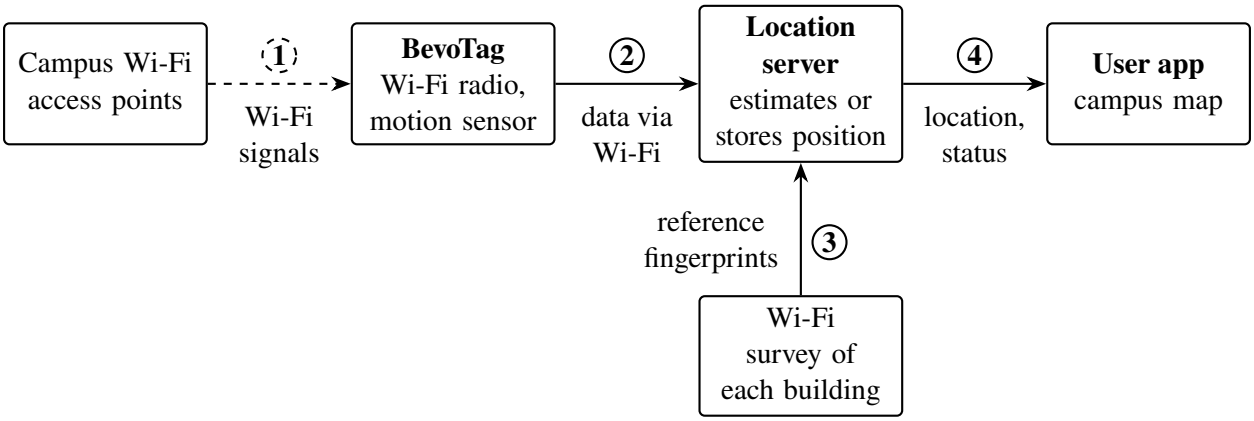


Figure 1. How BevoTag Locates a Tagged Item

The project includes a working prototype tag, its firmware, a Wi-Fi survey of designated test areas, and a user application. The tag will combine a Wi-Fi chip that can report CSI, such as the ESP32-S3 [9], with a low-noise IMU on a development board or a custom circuit board. Its firmware will read the sensors and either process the measurements or send them to the server. The survey will begin with EER and its adjacent outdoor plazas, and the application will display the tag's position on a campus map.

Four related capabilities fall outside the project's scope. The tag will not use a cellular Internet of Things connection such as LTE-M or NB-IoT, because these require a paid data plan and a second radio that would raise cost and power consumption, and campus Wi-Fi serves the target areas; the survey will confirm that coverage. The team will not survey every building on campus, because a survey requires walking each floor and recording measurements at many points. It will instead test in a few defined benchmark areas and document the survey method so that others can add buildings later. The team will 3D-print or buy the prototype enclosure rather than design it for injection molding, since the goal is a working proof of concept rather than a manufacturable product. Finally, BevoTag locates objects, not people, and the design excludes features that would follow a person, such as continuous covert tracking.

Design Challenges

Three challenges will most strongly shape the design: deciding where to compute the position, capturing CSI from radio signals that never repeat exactly, and correcting motion-sensor drift quickly enough. Each challenge requires a measurement on prototype hardware before the team can finalize the design.

The first challenge is deciding whether to compute the position on the tag or on the server. Processing CSI and running a fusion filter on a small microcontroller strain its memory and battery. Sending raw measurements to the server moves that work off the tag but keeps the radio on longer, which also drains the battery. The team will settle this trade-off by measuring CSI capture rates, IMU data rates, and power draw on the prototype.

The second challenge is capturing reliable CSI from signals that vary from moment to moment.

A receiver derives CSI from the training fields of frames that use orthogonal frequency-division multiplexing (OFDM) [9], so the tag must capture it from OFDM frames that nearby access points send, not from every frame it hears. The measurements recorded at a given spot also fluctuate with noise and with changes in the environment, such as people walking through hallways [1, Sec. III-B]. The team will therefore record survey measurements at several times of day and test the matching method on data that it did not use to build the survey.

The third challenge is correcting IMU drift before it grows large. The drift described in the Theory of Operation grows to more than 150 m within 60 s [4], so Wi-Fi fixes must arrive often enough, and be reliable enough, to keep the fused estimate from diverging from the true position. This requirement ties the Wi-Fi update rate to the accuracy targets in the Performance Specifications.

Relevant Standards

Seven standards and policies constrain how BevoTag uses the radio spectrum, connects its sensors, protects its data, powers itself, and uses the campus network. Their most direct effects are that the tag must use a Wi-Fi chip that exposes CSI and a pre-certified radio module, keep its sensor drivers separate from its estimation code, encrypt its telemetry, use a certified and protected lithium battery, and act as an ordinary network client. Appendix A lists the specific clauses of each standard, how each affects the design, and how the team will verify compliance.

IEEE 802.11 [12] limits BevoTag to Wi-Fi chips that expose CSI and governs how the tag joins campus networks. The standard defines how Wi-Fi devices format and exchange signals, including the training fields at the start of every OFDM frame from which a receiver derives CSI [9].

Federal Communications Commission (FCC) rules in Title 47 of the Code of Federal Regulations (C.F.R.), Part 15 [13], lead the team to use a Wi-Fi module that already holds FCC approval. Part 15 limits both the intended Wi-Fi transmissions and the unintended electrical noise that the tag's processor and circuits emit, so that the tag does not interfere with campus communications. Section 15.212 lets a radio module receive its own modular approval and requires the product that

contains it to display a label referring to the module's FCC identifier (FCC ID) [13, §15.212], which makes such a module the most practical way to meet these limits.

IEEE 1451.0 [14], the base standard of the IEEE 1451 smart transducer family, leads the team to separate sensor drivers from the position-estimation code. The standard describes how sensors should present their data and calibration information to a processor. Following its approach lets the team replace either sensor without rewriting the fusion algorithm.

National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) Special Publication 800-88 [15] and Federal Information Processing Standard (FIPS) 140-3 [16] determine how the tag encrypts its reports and how a factory reset erases its memory. These federal guidelines cover the erasure of stored data and the cryptographic methods that protect data, and they apply because the tag stores network credentials and location history.

International Electrotechnical Commission (IEC) standard 62133-2 [17] sets the safety requirements for the rechargeable lithium battery that powers the tag. Its tests address overcharge, short circuit, and overheating, so the team will choose a certified cell and add a protection circuit on its own board.

The university's acceptable use policy (AUP) [18] governs how the tag may use the campus network. It forbids deliberately scanning or probing any information resource without authorization and interfering with other users' activities, which reinforces the ethical commitments below.

Ethical Considerations

Because BevoTag's purpose is to report location, it creates obligations to people beyond its owner. The team commits to five measures: recording only the signal measurements needed for positioning, protecting stored location data, never disrupting the campus network, protecting users from battery hazards and electronic waste, and honoring the licenses of the software and map data the project uses.

The firmware will record only signal measurements and packet header fields, never the content of anyone's network traffic. To capture CSI, the tag listens to Wi-Fi traffic that may come from other people's devices. It will keep only the fields needed for positioning, such as the access point address and signal strength, and it will not decode, store, or transmit the contents of any packet.

The team will treat location history as personal information, because a history of where an item has been reveals where its owner has been. The team will encrypt data in transit between the tag and the server and restrict server access to the authenticated owner of each tag. It will also delete stored location history at the end of the project and ensure that a factory reset erases stored credentials and history, consistent with the guidelines in Appendix A.

The tag will use the campus network only as an ordinary client. It will listen passively or connect through networks, such as utexas-iot, that the university provides for devices of this kind [8]. It will never transmit traffic designed to disrupt, congest, or probe the security of UT Austin's network.

The design will protect people from battery hazards and limit electronic waste. The tag carries a small lithium battery near people and their belongings, so it will include protection against overcharging, short circuits, and overheating. To limit waste, the team will favor a rechargeable battery over disposable cells and will document how to dispose of the prototype's battery properly.

The team will respect the intellectual property of others. The firmware, server, and application will build on third-party libraries and map data whose licenses may require attribution or limit redistribution. The team will record the license of each component it uses, comply with those terms, and cite the published research behind its methods in every project document.

Project Deliverables

At the end of EE 464, the team will deliver to Dr. Vikalo an integrated prototype that estimates and displays the location of a tagged item within the surveyed campus areas, together with the data and documentation needed to extend it. The delivery will consist of six items:

- **BevoTag hardware device:** a compact, battery-powered tag in an enclosure that collects Wi-Fi and motion measurements and sends them to the location server.
- **Embedded firmware:** software on the tag that reads the sensors, timestamps each measurement, monitors device status, and communicates over Wi-Fi.
- **Campus survey and map:** Wi-Fi survey data and a digital 3D map of the designated test areas that together let the system estimate, display, and evaluate the tag's location.
- **Localization backend:** server software that receives data from each tag, produces or stores its position estimate, and provides the result to the user application.
- **User application:** a web or mobile application in which a user can view a tag's estimated location and status on the campus map.
- **Documentation:** the source code, the survey procedure, and test results measured against the specifications in this report.

Requirements Specification

A successful BevoTag implementation must place a tagged item in the correct room in more than 90% of trials, keep its median position error under 5 m, update the item's location at least every 10 s while the item moves, and run at least 24 hours on one battery charge. The tables in this subsection set these and the other measurable targets for the system's inputs and outputs, user interface, operating environment, and performance, without prescribing an implementation. The team set these targets from published Wi-Fi positioning results [3] and its own judgment of what makes a tracker useful, and it will confirm them with Dr. Vikalo before detailed design.

Input and Output Specifications

The BevoTag system has three components (the tag, a backend server, and the user application), and its primary inputs are Wi-Fi signals and the tag's own motion. Its outputs are the tag's estimated position, the time of that estimate, and the tag's status, which the application shows to the user. Figure 2 on the next page diagrams these connections, and a table that follows it sets the value of each input and output.

The diagram shows that every measurement enters through the tag and every output leaves through the application. The tag measures Wi-Fi signals, motion, and, optionally, GNSS signals,

and it sends these measurements and its status to the server as telemetry. The server holds the building survey and map, produces or receives the position estimate, and exchanges location, status, and tag selections with the application. A USB-C port charges the tag's battery and lets a computer running the application configure and debug the tag.

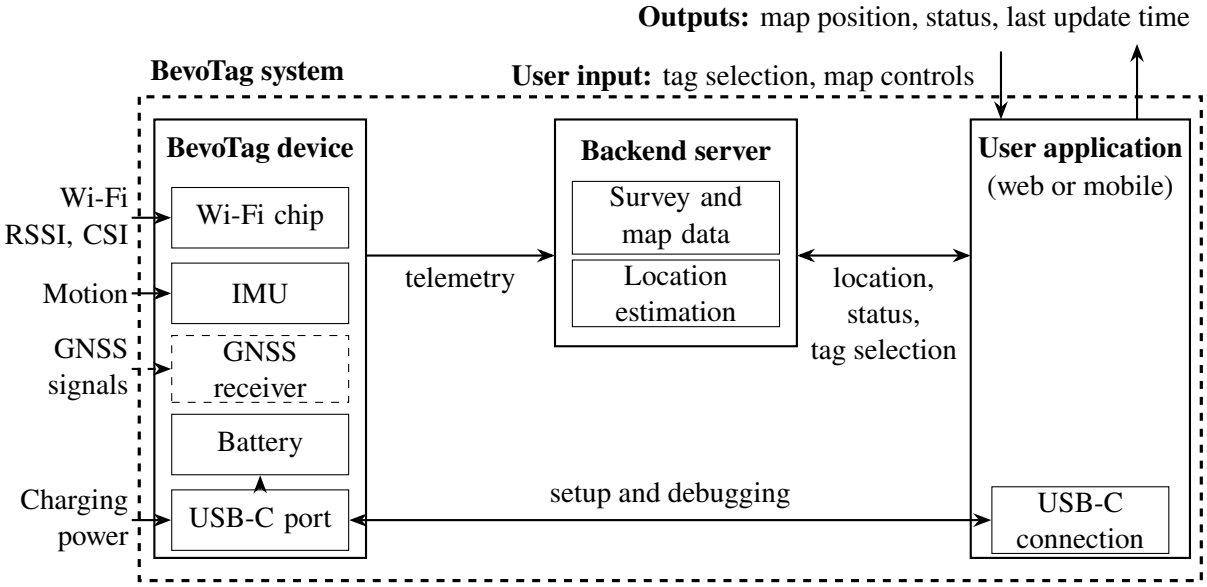


Figure 2. BevoTag Input and Output Diagram (Dashed Items Are Optional)

The tag must measure signals as weak as −100 dBm and report at least every 10 s while it moves, and the application must display each new estimate within 1 s of receiving it. Table 1 on the next page gives these and the other values for each input and output in Figure 2. GNSS appears only as an optional input for open outdoor areas.

User Interface Specifications

The user application must let a user select a tag, see its estimated location and the time of that estimate on a 3D campus map, and check its status, and it must accept a direct USB-C connection to a tag for configuration and debugging. Table 2 on the next page sets a value for each of these requirements. The most important is the location display, which must show each new estimate within 1 s of the estimate's arrival in the application. The initial implementation may be either a web or a mobile application, provided that it meets every requirement in the table.

Table 1. BevoTag Input and Output Specifications

Input/Output	Description	Value or Range
Wi-Fi RSSI input	Strength of each Wi-Fi signal	−100 to −30 dBm
Wi-Fi CSI input	Frequency response per sub-carrier [9]	64 entries per 20 MHz field
Acceleration input	Linear acceleration from the IMU	±8 g
Angular rate input	Rotation rate from the IMU	±1000 degrees/s
GNSS input (optional)	Satellite position outdoors	Latitude and longitude
Charging power input	Power that charges the battery	5 V through USB-C
Survey fingerprint input	Measurements at known points	At least one per surveyed room
User input	Tag selection and map controls	Up to five tags per user
Telemetry output	Data sent from tag to server	At most 10 s apart while moving
Location output	Estimated position of the tag	Latitude, longitude, and floor
Timestamp output	Time of the latest estimate	Resolution of 1 s
Device status output	Battery level and connectivity	0 to 100% charge; online or offline
Display refresh output	Time from estimate arrival to display	At most 1 s

Table 2. User Interface Specifications

Interface	Requirement	Value or Criterion
Device location	Show the tag on a 3D campus map	Building, floor, and position, within 1 s of each estimate's arrival
Device selection	Select the tag to monitor	Up to five tags per user
Last update time	Show when the system estimated the position	Date and time to 1 s
Device status	Show battery level and connectivity	Battery percentage; online or offline
Map interaction	Pan, zoom, and change floors	Response within 1 s of each input
USB-C connection	Configure and debug a connected tag	Application recognizes the tag within 5 s

Operating Environment Specifications

BevoTag must operate in the physical conditions of the surveyed campus zones and within the computing and network environment that the university and the team provide, and Table 3 on

the next page sets both. Physically, the tag must work at every survey point that receives at least three access points, from 0 to 40 °C, while a person carries it at up to 5 m/s; it need not survive rain. The computing and network environment matters because most of BevoTag's function is software. The tag's firmware must fit in a microcontroller's memory, and the tag must join the utexas-iot network and encrypt its telemetry in transit. The backend must run on a Linux server reachable from campus, and the application must run in current browsers or on current phones.

Table 3. Operating Environment Specifications

Condition	Description	Value or Criterion
Physical environment		
Deployment area	Indoor floors and outdoor plazas that the team surveys	Every survey point, beginning with EER and its adjacent plazas
Wi-Fi coverage	Campus access points received at each survey point	At least three, each stronger than −80 dBm
Temperature	Ambient temperature for correct operation	0 to 40 °C
Moisture	Water exposure the tag must tolerate	Dry indoor and outdoor use; no rain or immersion
User motion	Speed of the person carrying the tag	0 to 5 m/s
Computing and network environment		
Tag processor	Battery-powered microcontroller with integrated Wi-Fi	Firmware fits in at most 512 KB of RAM
Tag network	Campus network that carries telemetry	utexas-iot at 2.4 GHz with Wi-Fi Protected Access 2 (WPA2) [8]
Data transport	Protection of telemetry between tag and server	Transport Layer Security (TLS) 1.2 or later
Backend host	Server that receives telemetry and serves the application	Linux virtual machine reachable from campus, with at least two CPU cores and 4 GB of memory
Application platform	Devices that run the user application	Current Chrome, Firefox, and Safari browsers, or iOS 17 and Android 13 and later

Performance Specifications

Room identification is the governing accuracy target in Table 4 on the next page, which also sets targets for timeliness, battery life, size, and cost. RSSI fingerprinting can already reach errors of

1 to 5 m under favorable conditions [3, Table 4], so the 5 m median error is a ceiling, whereas placing a moving tag in the correct room in more than 90% of trials as conditions change is the result that BevoTag must add. The team will measure accuracy at surveyed points whose true positions it has recorded independently of BevoTag's estimate, in stationary and moving trials indoors and outdoors, and it will repeat the trials at different times of day to capture changing conditions such as pedestrian traffic.

Table 4. Performance Specifications

Parameter	Description	Value or Range	Units
Room identification	Fraction of trials in which the system places the tag in the correct surveyed room or outdoor survey region	> 90	%
Floor identification	Fraction of indoor trials in which the system places the tag on the correct floor	> 95	%
Median position error	Median horizontal distance between estimated and true position	< 5	m
Update interval	Maximum time between location estimates while the tag moves	≤ 10	s
End-to-end latency	Maximum time from a tag measurement to the resulting position on the application's display	< 5	s
Time to first fix	Maximum time from startup to the first usable position estimate	< 30	s
IMU sampling rate	Accelerometer and gyroscope sampling rate during active tracking	≥ 100	Hz
Battery life	Time on one charge, moving 10% of the time with 10-s reports and otherwise reporting once per minute	≥ 24	h
Tag size	Largest dimensions of the tag in its enclosure	$\leq 80 \times 50 \times 25$	mm
Tag mass	Mass of the tag with battery and enclosure	≤ 100	g
Parts cost	Cost of components for one prototype tag	≤ 50	US$

TEAM ORGANIZATION

The five-member team has organized itself into two sub-teams under a Project Lead: Embedded Hardware and Firmware, which builds the tag, and Localization and Application Software, which turns measurements into a location and shows it to the user. Each member's assignment matches that member's coursework and experience, and all members share integration, testing, and documentation. Team policies set how members communicate, hold one another accountable, and resolve disagreements.

Project Roles

The team divided its work at the boundary between the tag and the software that interprets the tag's data, and it added two team-wide roles to coordinate across that boundary. Two members form each sub-team, and the Project Lead and the Documentation Lead hold the team-wide roles.

Sub-Teams

The hardware sub-team builds the tag, and the software sub-team turns the tag's data into a displayed location. The Embedded Hardware and Firmware sub-team, Esteban Martinez and Li Shi, will first build a data logger for feasibility experiments and Wi-Fi survey collection. It will then integrate the required processing on the tag and evaluate measurement reliability, execution time, memory use, and power consumption. The Localization and Application Software sub-team, Andrew Yin and Abhirit Das, owns survey data processing, the position-estimation pipeline, the backend that receives and manages tag data, the 3D campus map, and the user application. The two sub-teams will integrate the tag, the positioning software, and the application, and all members will take part in system testing.

Personnel and Team-Wide Roles

Each member's assignment follows from that member's coursework and experience, and Table 5 on the next page summarizes the assignments. Ethan Chua's positioning research suits the Project Lead role and the fusion algorithm, Esteban Martinez's and Li Shi's embedded systems experience suits the tag, and Andrew Yin's and Abhirit Das's application and machine-learning experience suits the software. Ethan serves as Project Lead, and Andrew serves as Documentation Lead, who checks every submission against the ECE Style Guide.

Table 5. Project Responsibilities

Member	Sub-Team or Role	Planned Contributions	Areas of Expertise	Related Coursework
Ethan Chua	Project Lead	Coordination, integration, verification, fusion guidance	Radio positioning, GNSS, signal processing	ECE 351M
Esteban Martinez	Embedded Hardware and Firmware	Components, power system, hardware integration	Embedded hardware design	ECE 445L, 422C, 360C
Li Shi	Embedded Hardware and Firmware	Firmware, sensor drivers, Wi-Fi communication	Embedded firmware design	ECE 445L, 422C, 360C
Andrew Yin	Localization and Application Software; Documentation Lead	Survey processing, localization, backend	Mobile development, machine learning	ECE 445L, 422C, 360C
Abhirit Das	Localization and Application Software	User application, 3D campus map, status display	Web development, machine-learning deployment	ECE 445L, 422C, 360C

Ethan Chua will lead the project and guide the design of the fusion algorithm. Ethan brings positioning research experience from the UT Radionavigation Laboratory, project experience from Texas Aerial Robotics, and signal processing preparation from ECE 351M, Digital Signal Processing. As Project Lead, Ethan will coordinate milestones, track progress, lead integration testing, and serve as the primary contact with Dr. Vikalo and the Technical TA.

Esteban Martinez will lead the tag's hardware, and Li Shi will lead its firmware. Esteban will select components, design the power system, integrate the hardware, and run electrical tests. Li will develop the firmware for Wi-Fi CSI and RSSI capture, IMU sampling, measurement timestamping, and network communication. Both have completed ECE 445L, Embedded Systems Design Lab; ECE 422C, Software Design and Implementation II; and ECE 360C, Algorithms, and both have embedded systems experience through Texas Aerial Robotics and industry internships.

Andrew Yin will lead survey processing, position estimation, and the backend, and Abhirit Das will lead the user application and the 3D campus map. Andrew's experience in mobile application development and machine learning applies to fingerprint matching and sensor fusion. Abhirit's experience in web application development and in profiling machine-learning deployment tools at NXP Semiconductors applies to the application and its interface testing. Both have completed the same three courses as the hardware sub-team.

Team Policies

The team's policies set how members communicate, what they owe one another, and how the team decides questions and resolves conflict. Members use Discord for daily communication and GitHub for code and task tracking, attend two team meetings each week and a mentor meeting every two weeks, and finish work 48 hours before each course deadline. They review one another's work, decide significant questions by majority vote after research, and settle technical disagreements with data.

Project Management Tools

The team coordinates through four shared platforms. Discord is the primary communication channel, with separate channels for general coordination, each sub-team, and meeting logistics so that discussions stay organized and searchable. A shared Google Calendar holds meeting times, course deadlines, and internal milestones. A shared GitHub repository keeps firmware, application code, data-processing scripts, and circuit board and enclosure designs under version control, and GitHub Issues and a GitHub Projects board record each task's owner, due date, and status. A shared Google Drive folder stores reports, meeting notes, and survey data. The Project Lead handles email with Dr. Vikalo and the Technical TA and copies the full team, so every member receives the same guidance.

Team Expectations

Members respond promptly, come to meetings prepared, review one another's work, and finish work 48 hours before each course deadline. The Conflict Resolution policy states how the team responds when a member does not meet these expectations.

Members respond within 24 hours and come to every meeting prepared. They answer direct questions on Discord within 24 hours on weekdays and flag time-sensitive issues, such as a blocked task or an approaching deadline, by mentioning the affected members directly. The team meets twice a week and meets with Dr. Vikalo every two weeks. Members review the agenda before each meeting, notify the team on Discord at least 24 hours before an unavoidable absence, and read the notes and follow up on their action items after any meeting they miss. At the start of each meeting, members report what they completed, what they plan to do next, and any blockers, and the Project Lead records these updates and keeps the Projects board current.

Every piece of work passes a second member's review before it leaves its author. The reviewer checks each pull request before the team merges it, each circuit board design before the team orders boards, and each written section against the ECE Style Guide before submission.

Internal deadlines fall at least 48 hours before each course deadline so that the team has time to integrate, review, and revise its work. Members who expect to miss an internal deadline tell the team at least 48 hours in advance, so that the team can re-scope or redistribute the work.

Conflict Resolution

The team makes significant decisions by majority vote after research, settles technical disputes with tests, mediates interpersonal conflicts, and answers missed responsibilities in escalating steps. Unresolved technical risks go to Dr. Vikalo or the Technical TA, and unresolved conflicts go to the Technical TA or the course instructor.

The team makes significant decisions, such as selecting a positioning approach, choosing components, or changing the project scope, by majority vote after researching the options. The members most familiar with the question present the trade-offs of each option, supported by datasheets, published results, cost estimates, or the team's own measurements, and the Project Lead records the outcome and its rationale in the meeting notes. Each sub-team makes decisions that affect only its own work and reports them at the next meeting. When the two members of a sub-team disagree, the Project Lead breaks the tie.

The team settles technical disagreements with data. Where practical, it runs a quick test or trade study against the performance specifications in Table 4 before voting. It brings any unresolved disagreement that poses significant risk to the project to Dr. Vikalo or the Technical TA.

Members first address interpersonal conflicts privately with one another. If that conversation does not resolve the issue, an uninvolved member mediates. The team escalates any conflict that it cannot resolve internally to the Technical TA or the course instructor.

The team responds to missed responsibilities in escalating steps. The Project Lead first raises a missed commitment privately with the member to understand the cause and agree on a recovery plan. The team discusses repeated missed deadlines or meetings at a team meeting and records the corrective actions in the notes. If the problem continues, the team notifies the Technical TA and the course instructor and reports each member's contributions accurately in peer evaluations.

CONCLUSION

This Project Definition establishes what the BevoTag team must build and how the team will work together to build it. Because satellite positioning fails inside buildings and existing tags depend on other people's phones, the team will build a low-cost tag that locates an item on campus by matching Wi-Fi measurements against a building survey and fusing them with motion-sensor data. The design must place the item in the correct room in more than 90% of trials, within the limits that radio, data-security, and battery standards and the team's ethical commitments set. Two sub-teams under a Project Lead will do the work under shared policies for communication, review, and decisions. Success depends on three risks, and the team's next steps begin to reduce them.

Reliable positioning where satellite signals fail matters beyond lost laptops. Indoor location-based services have both social and commercial value, with a market that one survey predicted would reach US$10 billion by 2020 [1, Sec. I], and the same need applies to shared lab equipment that moves among rooms. The project's outcome depends on three risks: the tag must capture CSI on low-power hardware, room-level accuracy depends on careful building surveys, and campus network coverage and access policies may limit where the tag can operate.

If CSI capture proves unreliable, signal-strength fingerprinting fused with motion data remains a fallback at reduced accuracy. With that fallback and the team's experience in embedded systems, positioning research, and software development, a working prototype within a few surveyed buildings is a realistic outcome.

Next, the team will confirm the specification targets with Dr. Vikalo, complete a data logger for initial Wi-Fi and IMU measurements, and survey EER as the first test building. It will then refine the system block diagram and component selection, and each member will plan an individual risk reduction activity in that member's area of the design.

REFERENCES

[1] S. He and S.-H. G. Chan, "Wi-Fi fingerprint-based indoor positioning: Recent advances and comparisons," *IEEE Commun. Surveys Tuts.*, vol. 18, no. 1, pp. 466–490, 1st Quart. 2016, doi: 10.1109/COMST.2015.2464084.

[2] Apple Inc. (2026). *AirTag* [Online]. Available: https://www.apple.com/airtag/.

[3] A. S. Yaro, F. Maly, and P. Prazak, "A survey of the performance-limiting factors of a 2-dimensional RSS fingerprinting-based indoor wireless localization system," *Sensors*, vol. 23, no. 5, art. no. 2545, Feb. 2023, doi: 10.3390/s23052545.

[4] O. J. Woodman, "An introduction to inertial navigation," Comput. Lab., Univ. Cambridge, Cambridge, U.K., Tech. Rep. UCAM-CL-TR-696, Aug. 2007, doi: 10.48456/tr-696.

[5] J. E. Yoder and T. E. Humphreys, "Low-cost inertial aiding for deep-urban tightly coupled multi-antenna precise GNSS," *NAVIGATION*, vol. 70, no. 1, art. no. navi.561, Mar. 2023, doi: 10.33012/navi.561.

[6] National Coordination Office for Space-Based Positioning, Navigation, and Timing. (n.d.). *Space Segment* [Online]. Available: https://www.gps.gov/space-segment.

[7] Samsung Electronics Canada. (n.d.). *Galaxy SmartTag2* [Online]. Available: https://www.samsung.com/ca/business/mobile-accessories/galaxy-smarttag2-white-ei-t5600bwegca/.

[8] The University of Texas at Austin. (2025, Aug. 25). *Connecting to utexas-iot Wi-Fi* [Online]. Available: https://ut.service-now.com/kb_view.do?sysparm_article=KB0017215.

[9] Espressif Systems. (2026). *ESP-IDF Programming Guide (ESP32-S3): Wi-Fi Vendor Features* [Online]. Available: https://docs.espressif.com/projects/esp-idf/en/stable/esp32s3/api-guides/wifi-driver/wifi-vendor-features.html.

[10] Z. Yang, Z. Zhou, and Y. Liu, "From RSSI to CSI: Indoor localization via channel response," *ACM Comput. Surv.*, vol. 46, no. 2, art. no. 25, pp. 1–32, Nov. 2013, doi: 10.1145/2543581.2543592.

[11] G. Welch and G. Bishop, "An introduction to the Kalman filter," Dept. Comput. Sci., Univ. North Carolina, Chapel Hill, Tech. Rep. TR 95-041, Apr. 2004.

[12] *IEEE Standard for Information Technology—Telecommunications and Information Exchange between Systems—Local and Metropolitan Area Networks—Specific Requirements—Part 11: Wireless LAN Medium Access Control (MAC) and Physical Layer (PHY) Specifications*, IEEE Standard 802.11-2020, Feb. 2021, doi: 10.1109/IEEESTD.2021.9363693.

[13] *Radio Frequency Devices*, 47 C.F.R. Part 15, 2025.

[14] *IEEE Standard for a Smart Transducer Interface for Sensors and Actuators—Common Functions, Communication Protocols, and Transducer Electronic Data Sheet (TEDS) Formats*, IEEE Standard 1451.0-2024, Jun. 2024, doi: 10.1109/IEEESTD.2024.10571828.

[15] R. Chandramouli and E. A. Hibbard, "Guidelines for media sanitization," Nat. Inst. Standards Technol., Gaithersburg, MD, NIST Special Publication 800-88 Rev. 2, Sept. 2025, doi: 10.6028/NIST.SP.800-88r2.

[16] *Security Requirements for Cryptographic Modules*, FIPS PUB 140-3, Mar. 2019.

[17] *Secondary Cells and Batteries Containing Alkaline or Other Non-Acid Electrolytes—Safety Requirements for Portable Sealed Secondary Cells, and for Batteries Made from Them, for Use in Portable Applications—Part 2: Lithium Systems*, IEC Standard 62133-2:2017, Feb. 2017.

[18] The University of Texas at Austin Information Security Office. (2019, Aug. 28). *Acceptable Use Policy for University Students* [Online]. Available: https://security.utexas.edu/policies/aup.

APPENDIX A – APPLICABLE STANDARDS

The seven standards and policies in this appendix require BevoTag to use a Wi-Fi chip that exposes CSI and a pre-certified radio module, to separate its sensor drivers from its estimation code, to encrypt its telemetry and erase its memory on reset, to use a certified and protected lithium battery, and to use the campus network only as an ordinary client. For each standard, a table lists the clauses that affect BevoTag, and the paragraph before the table states how the team will verify compliance.

IEEE 802.11: Wi-Fi Physical and Medium Access Control Layers

IEEE 802.11 [12] determines both how BevoTag can measure CSI and how it may join campus networks. Table 6 shows that the physical-layer clauses decide which chips can report CSI, whereas the frame, management, and security clauses decide how the tag listens and authenticates. The team will verify CSI capture by comparing recorded sub-carrier data from OFDM frames of known access points across repeated visits to the same survey point. It will confirm through a Wireshark packet capture that the tag sends only ordinary client traffic, and it will confirm network association through connection logs on utexas-iot.

Table 6. IEEE 802.11 Requirements Affecting BevoTag

Clause	Requirement	Effect on Design
Clauses 17, 18, and 19 [12] (OFDM, extended-rate, and high-throughput physical layers)	Define the sub-carrier structure and the training fields at the start of each OFDM frame	The Wi-Fi chip must expose per-sub-carrier CSI from these training fields [9]
Clause 9 [12] (frame formats)	Defines frame headers, including the transmitter address	Firmware keeps only header fields, such as the access point address
Clause 11 [12] (management)	Defines scanning and association	Tag scans and associates as an ordinary client
Clause 12 [12] (security)	Defines robust security network association, including pre-shared keys	Tag authenticates with the WPA2 pre-shared key that utexas-iot issues [8]

FCC 47 C.F.R. Part 15: Radio Frequency Devices

Part 15 [13] limits both intentional transmissions and unintended emissions from the tag's digital circuits. As Table 7 shows, a pre-certified Wi-Fi module already satisfies the transmitter and restricted-band limits, which leaves the team responsible mainly for board layout and labeling. The team will verify conducted output power on a bench spectrum analyzer and check the board for unintended emissions with a near-field probe, rather than performing full certification testing.

Table 7. FCC Part 15 Requirements Affecting BevoTag

Section	Requirement	Effect on Design
§15.109 (unintentional radiators)	Radiated emission limits for Class B digital devices [13, §15.109]	Processor clocks, sensor buses, and power conversion need careful layout and decoupling
§15.247(b) (intentional radiators)	Conducted output power of at most 1 W (30 dBm) in the 2400–2483.5 MHz band, with antenna gain up to 6 dBi [13, §15.247(b)]	Use a pre-certified Wi-Fi module whose output stays within this limit
§15.205, §15.209, and §15.247(d) (restricted bands)	Limits on harmonics, band-edge, and spurious emissions [13]	Rely on the certified module's filtering and follow its antenna layout rules
§15.19 and §15.212 (labeling)	Part 15 compliance statement and a "Contains FCC ID" label for a modular radio [13, §15.212]	Enclosure carries the compliance statement and the module's FCC ID
§15.21 (information to user)	Warning that unapproved changes void the user's authority to operate [13, §15.21]	Documentation includes the required warning

IEEE 1451.0: Smart Transducer Interface

IEEE 1451.0 [14] guides how the firmware separates sensor hardware from the processing that uses its data. Table 8 on the next page shows that the team will adopt the standard's data model and data sheet structure rather than its full command set, which would use more memory than the tag can spare. The team will check compliance through firmware review and unit tests confirming that calibration data load correctly at startup.

Table 8. IEEE 1451.0 Guidelines Affecting BevoTag

Provision	Guideline	Effect on Design
Transducer channel model	Each sensor appears to the processor as a set of standard channels	A hardware abstraction layer separates the IMU and Wi-Fi drivers from the fusion algorithm
Transducer electronic data sheets (TEDS)	Each sensor carries self-describing identification and calibration data	Firmware stores IMU scale factors and bias offsets in flash in a defined format
Common communication functions	Sensors exchange data and status through defined message formats	Telemetry packets carry IMU, Wi-Fi, and battery data in a defined format

NIST SP 800-88 and FIPS 140-3: Data Sanitization and Cryptography

These federal guidelines [15], [16] govern how the tag protects and erases the credentials and location history it stores. Table 9 shows that a factory reset will both overwrite stored data and destroy the encryption keys. It also shows that telemetry and firmware will follow FIPS 140-3 practices by relying only on approved algorithms, although the team will not seek formal module validation. To verify these measures, the team will read back flash memory through a debug probe after a factory reset and check encryption against published NIST test vectors. It will also attempt to load an unsigned firmware image to confirm that secure boot rejects it.

Table 9. Data Security Requirements Affecting BevoTag

Section	Requirement	Effect on Design
SP 800-88 Clear [15, Sec. 3.1.1]	Protect against simple recovery through the device's normal interface, for example by a reset to factory state	Factory reset overwrites stored credentials, location history, and survey tables
SP 800-88 Purge by cryptographic erase [15, Sec. 3.2]	Sanitize the keys that encrypt stored data so that no one can decrypt the data	Reset erases the keys held in the chip's secure storage
FIPS 140-3 approved security functions [16]	Use approved algorithms, such as the Advanced Encryption Standard (AES) and SHA-256	Firmware encrypts telemetry with AES using the chip's hardware accelerator
FIPS 140-3 software and firmware security [16]	Verify firmware integrity with an approved integrity technique, such as a digital signature	Secure boot accepts only signed firmware images

IEC 62133-2: Lithium Battery Safety

IEC 62133-2 [17] sets safety requirements for the lithium cell and battery that power the tag. Table 10 shows that its tests target the same hazards that the Ethical Considerations identify, so the team will buy a cell already certified to the standard and add charge and short-circuit protection on its own board. The team will verify that protection on the bench by checking the charge cutoff voltage, the short-circuit cutoff, and the charge current against the cell's datasheet limits.

Table 10. IEC 62133-2 Requirements Affecting BevoTag

Provision	Requirement	Effect on Design
Overcharging of battery (7.3.6) [17]	Battery must not catch fire or explode when a charger exceeds its limits	Charger limits voltage and current to the cell's rated values
External short circuit (7.3.1, 7.3.2) [17]	Cell and battery must not catch fire or explode when their terminals short	Protection circuit disconnects the cell on overcurrent
Thermal abuse (7.3.4) [17]	Cell must withstand elevated temperature without fire or explosion	Board layout keeps the cell away from heat sources
Certified cells [17]	Cells must pass the standard's type tests	Team buys only cells certified to IEC 62133-2

UT Austin Acceptable Use Policy

The university's acceptable use policy [18] and its registration rules for utexas-iot [8] govern how the tag uses the campus network. Table 11 on the next page shows that the policy's limits on probing and interference match the tag's design as an ordinary network client. The team will verify compliance by reviewing the firmware's network functions against the policy and by confirming with a Wireshark capture that the tag sends only its own telemetry and ordinary client traffic.

Table 11. UT Austin Acceptable Use Policy Provisions Affecting BevoTag

Provision	Requirement	Effect on Design
AUP Sec. 5.10 (scanning) [18]	Never deliberately scan or probe an information resource without prior authorization	Tag never sends traffic that probes network security
AUP Sec. 5.7 (shared resources) [18]	Do not interfere with the activities of others or use a disproportionate share of information resources	Tag sends only small, periodic telemetry reports
utexas-iot registration [8]	Register each device's hardware address through the university's network portal	Team registers each tag and disables address randomization